

VertiGO!!!



Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 731 AUGUST 2010, PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON

A promotional poster for Jon Muir's International Speaker Tour. The background is a dark blue sky with a large, jagged rock formation in the foreground. A small figure of a person is visible on the peak of the rock. The text is white and yellow.

**JON
MUIR** INTERNATIONAL SPEAKER TOUR

WORLD ACCLAIMED MOUNTAINEER, POLAR AND DESERT EXPLORER

BROUGHT TO YOU BY

 **NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB**

WELLINGTON

Tuesday 31 August. 7.00pm.
MacLaurin Lecture Theatre MCLT102
Victoria University Campus.
NZAC members \$15. Non-members \$20.
Tickets available from NZAC section night
and Bivouac Outdoor, Mercer St.

For further information on Jon Muir go to:
www.alpineclub.org.nz/activities/speakertour/jon-muir-2010

sponsored by

 **WORLD
EXPEDITIONS**

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Next section night: 2 August 2010

Mountain Journeys from the Olivines to the Gardens by Geoff Spearpoint



This will be a romping traverse of some of the less visited areas in the Southern Alps as only someone like Geoff can do.

NZAC Wellington Section – Notice of 2010 Annual General Meeting

The 2010 Annual General Meeting of the Wellington Section of the NZ Alpine Club will be held:

Time: 8.00pm Monday 6th September

Venue: Turnbull House, Bowen St Wellington

An agenda, minutes of 2009 AGM, Chairperson's Annual Report for 2010, Treasurer's Report for 2010, and Financial Statement & Auditor's Report for 2010 are available from <http://www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz/?p=3589>

All nominations for committee positions should be sent to The Secretary, or alternatively nominations will be taken from the floor.

Please make every effort to attend.

JON MUIR

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Jon Muir, Australian mountaineer, Everest summitter and polar and desert explorer, is regarded as one of the great adventurers of the last century. He was making epic ascents in the Himalaya's at a very young age, has trekked to both the North and South Poles, and several years ago made an unsupported trek the length of Australia; a feat he says that made all his other accomplishments pale in significance.

John is a true 'character' and his speaker tours in Australia have been feted as 'genius'. He will be touring New Zealand in late August/ early September. Don't miss your opportunity to hear his fascinating story.

Where: MacLaurin lecture theatre MCLT102, Victoria University Kelburn Campus

Date & Time: Tuesday 31 August, 7pm

Get Tickets: Tickets are \$15 for members and \$20 non-members. They will be on sale at NZAC clubnights or from Bivouac Outdoor on Mercer St. For more information contact Steve Minchin at sm@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



TRIP REPORTS

Please send your trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

Ruapehu South

The trip to Ruapehu South (led by Adam Power) was blessed with fantastic weather and great conditions. The photos, all courtesy of Adam, can speak for themselves.







UPCOMING CLUB TRIPS



Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Ruapehu North - Te Heu Heu, Dome, and Paretetaitonga

Date: 13-15 August 2010

Leader: Peter Ellis

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

The plan is to drive up to Whakapapa, and climb up to Delta Corner Hut on Friday night. On Saturday we will stroll up to the crater, inspect the Dome shelter (2672m) and attempt Paratetaitonga (2751m), returning to Delta Corner for the evening. On Sunday we will return to the crater and attempt Te Heu Heu (2732m) along the main ridge, descending the skifield to the car park and home thereafter. Contact Peter at 021 934 482 (evenings) or email me at ellis@netspeed.com.au



Mt Taranaki / Egmont

Date: 10-12 September 2010

Leader: Richard Davidson

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Taranaki and walk in for 2h to Tahurangi Lodge. Saturday we will ascend to the crater and then summit of Taranaki. Those who are especially adventurous might like to have a go at Sharks Tooth. Sunday may involve a jaunt to Humpries Castle or the Organ Pipes for a bit of rock climbing. Contact Richard at 027 427 3467 or email richard.davidson@chapmantripp.com



Cycling to beat the petrel crisis!

Date: October 2 – 9 2010

Leader : Andy Maloney

Level: Anyone

The plan is to cycle from sea level (at Wellington) to the highest point of the North Island (Mt Ruapehu summit) via interesting backroads (as far as possible). Obviously the last bit will require some easy climbing/ snow plod. I'm doing this to raise money and awareness for a rat eradication on Henderson Island in the mid-pacific, and to stop them wiping out birdlife (including petrels) from the island - see www.killtherats.homestead.com. I'd really like some company, for all, or part of the journey. I will have a support vehicle, so you shouldn't have to carry too much gear on the bike, and can take up some ski gear to enjoy yourself on the slopes afterwards. If you can't join in, but support what I'm doing, donations can be made through my website - money goes via Forest and Bird so is tax deductible! Please contact me at nzmadvet@yahoo.co.nz or 04 9386539 / 021 664251



Mt Manukau and Te Ao Whekere – Seaward Kaikouras

Date: 22 – 26 October 2010 (Labour Weekend)

Leader: TBA

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Spring snow trip to end the northern alpine season! Come on this challenging 3 day climb in the Seaward Kaikouras. On Friday night we'll take the ferry and stay near the road end. Saturday will be the trip in up to a basin below Te Ao Whekere where we'll tent overnight. On Sunday we'll summit TAW and traverse along to Manakau then drop down to a ridge where we'll again tent overnight. On Monday we'll walk out down the Hapuku River. Keeping one spare day in reserve for weather. No ropes required. Contact Kevin 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Tasman Saddle

Date: 19 – 28 November 2010

Leader: TBA

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Set aside space in your leave calendar for this one! This will be a week long trip into the Mt Cook NP glacier zone. Multiple peaks abound within easy distance of Tasman Saddle Hut including Mt Green, Elie de Beaumont, and the infamous Hochstetter Dome. On Friday night we'll fly down to Christchurch and drive to Mt Cook village, staying in Unwin Hut. On Saturday we will fly in to Tasman Saddle by ski plane and spend the following 8 days climbing. Or whatever. Sunday lunchtime we fly back out, and then drive back to Christchurch to catch our plane home. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

The Wellington Tramping and Mountaineering Club invites you to...

A Winter Ball

This is a black tie affair which includes a dinner and dance so put your glad rags and dancing shoes on and come join the fun.

When - 21 August 2010

Where - The Long room at the Basin Reserve.

The Band is Jonny and the Dream boats.

Profits made will go to Wellington Search and Rescue

\$75 each for 2 or more early bird

\$80 each for a single early bird

\$90 each after 16th July

(early bird special prior to 16 July 2010)

To purchase tickets contact Donna Maher
social@wtmc.org.nz





NOTICES



Subscriptions increase from 1 October 2010

Back in May the Government announced several big changes in the 2010 budget – the most significant of these for NZAC was the change in GST rate. Like any organisation that sells a product or service, NZAC are profoundly impacted by any change like this. Hence CCM resolved at its 16 May meeting that the full member subscription rate will rise to \$105, to match the GST rise to 15 per cent. The full schedule of membership rates from 1 October 2010 will therefore be:

Full members	\$105
Students & Under 25yrs	\$70
Seniors (over 65yrs)	\$70
Veteran (35yrs+ club membership)	\$50
Additional members	half of the applicable rate

The rise in GST means NZAC has also revised its publications prices (more info to come), and confirmed that all hut fees will remain unchanged. Any questions – just contact the team at National office.



Kea Winter Survey

Do you, your family, friends or group spend time outdoors in the South Island climbing, skiing, tramping, hunting or working? Would you be able to help make simple recordings of kea on Saturday or Sunday afternoons in July? Do you know of anyone else who may be interested in helping out?

Check out the NZAC website (<http://alpineclub.org.nz/system/files/Kea+survey+2010.pdf>) to find out more and become a part of this survey.



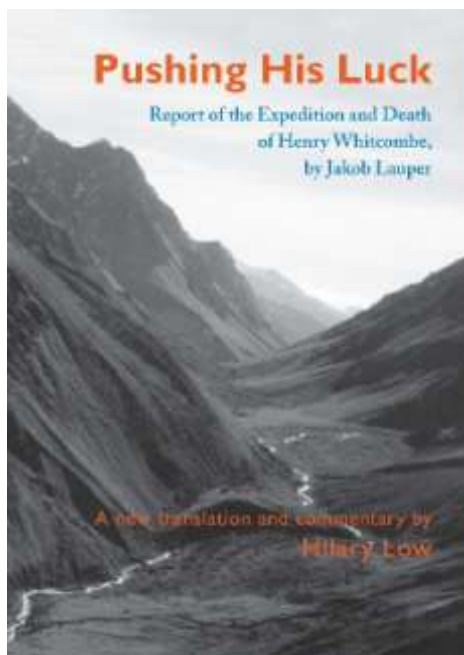
Metolius 10mm Hangers

NZAC has a new supply of 10mm hangers available for sale. Members \$5 each, non-members \$6.50 each + freight.

Orders can be placed online or direct from the National Office, at: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/product?filter0=28>



New Book Available – Pushing His Luck



The report of the Expedition and Death of Henry Whitcombe by Jakob Lauper. A new translation and commentary by Hilary Low.

We will be stocking copies of this new book, for a limited time, at a discounted member price of \$30.00 + \$4 p&p (non members \$40 + p&p). A review of this publication will be published in the Spring 'The Climber' Issue #73. Sales will become available from July 1st from the National Office and online:

<http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/pushing-his-luck>



Travel Insurance – Service Charge Increase

From August 1st 2010 the current \$20 service charge for processing NZAC travel Insurance applications will increase to \$40.



Freda Du Faur Mountain Skills for Women Course

December 3rd 2010 marks the centenary of Freda du Faur's ascent of Aoraki / Mt Cook- the first ever by a woman. To celebrate the New Zealand Alpine Club is hosting a six day alpine instruction course for women at Aoraki Mt Cook. The course is designed for women who have good basic mountaineering skills and a good level of fitness, and would like to move towards becoming self sufficient alpinists in glaciated mountain terrain.

The dates are: November 28th – December 3rd 2010. The cost of the course will be NZ\$950 - this will include six days instruction and a helicopter flight, and the instructors will be qualified female NZMGA guides.

There is also the capacity for women who took part in last year's High Alpine Skills Course to use this course to further develop their skills.

If you want to know more go to: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/default/24> or email pat@alpineclub.org.nz



Climbing women photos

As part of the upcoming centenary celebration of Freda du Faur's historic climb of Aoraki Mt Cook, Carla Braun-Elwert is putting together a collection of images of women climbing. These will be displayed on a big screen at the celebrations at Mt Cook on December 4th. If you would like to contribute an image / images towards this collection, please email: fredaphotos@gmail.com

Images need to be of mountaineering or rock climbing, and must feature women. Historic photos of women climbing will also be very welcome.



2011 NZAC Summer Climbing Camp

The N.Z.A.C 2011 Climbing Camp will be based at the Broken River Ski Club in the Craigieburn range from Sunday 2nd January to Sunday 9th January. The camp is being hosted by the Canterbury / Westland section of the NZAC.

Broken River will provide an ideal base and offer opportunities to all levels / ages of climbers, trampers, rock climbers and mountain bikers.

If travelling from Christchurch it is approx 1 hr 45 min drive to the skifield carpark by 2wd vehicle and only 20 minute walk to the lodges. You will be required to carry a pack to the lodges with the rest of your equipment being shuttled by 4wd.

The lodges will be available to all and can hold up to 80 people and for those who prefer to tent there is a public area with toilet, shelter and water 10 mins drive back down the bottom of the access road.

We plan to have an opening night bar barbeque on the evening of the 2nd with guest speakers and slide shows arranged. There will also be plenty of entertainment available during the week for those who stay on the hill and those with children but we will be encouraging all who attend to get away from the field for half, day and multi day adventures while the weather is favourable.

CLIMBING

Numerous mountaineering opportunities exist just 30 min drive away in Arthurs Pass. Peaks such as Mts Rolleston, Murchison, Franklin and Harper all offer different levels of challenge by the numerous face and ridge routes. There are also many other peaks in the surrounding areas to suit all.

TRAMPING

In the Craigieburn and Torlesse range as well as Arthurs Pass there is ample opportunity for half, day and multi day tramps. Cass-Lagoon, Casey-Binser, Minga-Deception and Edwards-Otehake are all popular trips as well as dozens of other opportunities to cater for all abilities.

ROCK CLIMBING

Castle Hill Basin offers world-class bouldering as well as rock climbing a mere 10 mins drive from Broken River. Multi-Pitch mountaineering routes also exist on Temple buttress, Speight buttress and the Otira face of Mt Rolleston and are all 30 mins drive away to start the approach walk.

MOUNTAINBIKING

Downhill and Off road trails are all very popular and easily accessed from Broken river with the Craigieburn forest park offering challenges to all levels.

Further Information as well as a full Climbing Camp Pamphlet will be available in the upcoming months. Registration forms can be obtained and downloaded from the N.Z.A.C Website or contact National Office on 03 3777595. A Camp Manager is still to be appointed but local contact for any questions/Information is Clayton Garbes on claytongarbes@hotmail.com or 0274461562 / 03 9607646 [eve].



NZAC 2009 Alpine Journal – SPECIAL OFFER

We have decided to put the remaining stock of 2009 Alpine Journals on sale. Price now only \$10 while stocks last. Purchase with Visa / MasterCard or by NZ bank transfer here: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/product/new-zealand-alpine-journal>



Advanced Alpine Skills Course

At the end of last year's High Alpine Skills Courses, some people asked the possibility of a 'follow-up' course to further develop their skills. The NZAC is offering those HASC participants from 2009 who have been actively climbing throughout the year and have an excellent level of fitness, the opportunity to take part in a six day "Advanced Alpine Skills Course" at Plateau Hut with a fully qualified NZMGA guide. The course will be "flying-in, walking-out."

The dates for the course are: December Sat 18 - December Thurs 23

Participants would be expected to arrive at Mt Cook on the afternoon of Dec 17.

The cost of the course is: NZ\$1250

This will cover: instruction fees, a helicopter flight, Plateau hut fees and administration costs. It does not cover hut fees for Unwin Hut before or after the course. Participants will be responsible for sourcing their own equipment and will bring their own food.

Contact: pat@alpineclub.org.nz



bushcraft.org.nz

Hi my name is Ryan Hunt, I am a member of the Alpine Sports Club and have been affiliated with LandSAR over the years. I have recently developed a network for bushcraft in NZ, a great passion of mine and of many other kiwis: www.bushcraft.org.nz

We have a big competition going at the moment to help spread the word with a Bushcraft Prizepack up for grabs, with an entry every time you tell a friend who signs up.

http://bushcraft.org.nz/profiles/blogs/armyshopconz-bushcraft?xg_source=activity

At heart we are just a bunch of kiwis who enjoy learning to be self sufficient in the bush and engaging in the natural world.



Volunteer Wardens for Mueller Hut Wanted

Want to spend a week in Aoraki / Mount Cook National Park this summer? The Department of Conservation is seeking volunteer wardens for Mueller Hut, a 28 bunk hut at 1800 m on the Sealy Range.

Wardens select a week, generally Monday to Monday, to spend at the hut between December and the end of April. After an orientation to the job on Monday morning, wardens climb up to the hut, move into the wardens quarters (a room with two bunks, a stove and small library) and provide information about the area to hut visitors. Major responsibilities include checking trampers in, responding to the 7 pm radio call (weather report and check-in), as well as cleaning the kitchen and toilet. There is plenty of time each day to explore the area and enjoy stunning views over Mount Sefton, Aoraki and the Hooker Valley.

There is no cost to warden at Mueller Hut and accommodation can be provided before and/or after your stay at Mueller in Aoraki / Mount Cook village.

Please contact Catherine Warren at cwarren@doc.govt.nz or 03 435 1186 if you are interested or would like more information.



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wn@fergskayaks.co.nz
www.fergskayaks.co.nz

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\$255



\$295



\$360



\$360



\$230

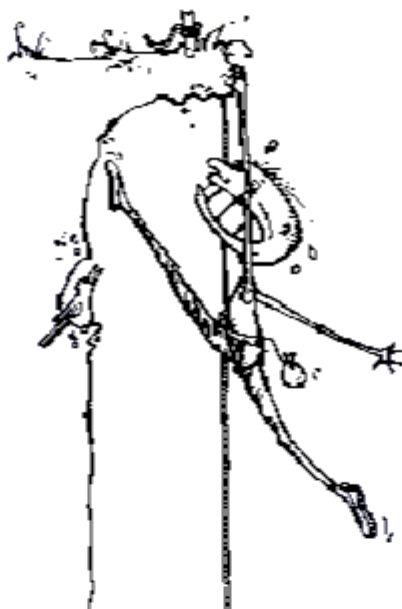


\$370



WELLINGTON SECTION: 2010/11 CONTACT LIST

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	Vacant	chairperson	
Vice Chair	Vacant	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h) 021 079 0854
Treasurer	Matt Knarston	treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
Instruction Convenor	Don French	DF	
Trips	Kevin Patterson	Trips or KP	04 934 0975 (h) 027 687 9573
Other Committee Members	Richard Davies	RD	
	Scott Taylor	ST	
	ShiChang Hou	SH	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Hinrich Schaefer		
	Rebecca Thomson		
Other Roles:			
Gear	Marcus Manning	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Kevin Patterson	PLB or KP	
Instruction - AIC	Don French	AIC or DF	06 3777 117 (h) 027 445 2980
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz	03 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
Wellington

